

KEYS

Africa's designated driver network.

A category infrastructure play for Bolt — built on the validated billion-dollar model from China, adapted for the markets where it actually works.

Africa is the worst place in the world to drink and drive.

SOUTH AFRICA

58%

of road deaths involve alcohol — nearly 3× the global average of 20%

R18.2B

annual economic cost of alcohol-related crashes

NIGERIA

21.4

road deaths per 100,000 people — among Africa's worst, weak DUI enforcement, no scalable alternative

WHAT PEOPLE DO INSTEAD

Two separate Bolt rides — one home, one back to retrieve the car in the morning.

Keys is price-competitive with the workaround, and removes the morning retrieval entirely.

₦16,000–30,000

- The morning car retrieval is worse than the night ride — it's the more painful, underserved half of the problem.
- People drive impaired because they don't trust an unknown Bolt driver with their keys — it's an identity trust problem, not a laziness problem.
- Nobody plans to drink and drive. The decision happens in the car park at 1am when everyone else is leaving.

We've lived this problem. Here's what we've observed.

DAY-1 CUSTOMER

30–45 entrepreneur, Lagos

Owns a vehicle worth ₦8M–25M. Active in Victoria Island and Lekki nightlife 2–4 nights per month. Has tried the two-Bolt workaround.

Owns the car. Cares about it. Has social capital to refer 3+ people after a single good experience.

The retrieval problem is worse than the night ride

Getting home is solved. Getting your car back at 9am from a venue 12 km away — with no breakfast, no ride, and a work call at 10 — is the part nobody talks about.

Trust blocks more decisions than price

Handing a ₦15M SUV to an anonymous driver feels riskier than driving impaired. The barrier isn't cost awareness — it's identity verification at the moment of key handoff.

The decision happens at 1am in a car park

Nobody plans to drink and drive. The decision is made when everyone else is leaving and there's no pre-booked alternative. Booking at 8pm is the only intervention that works.

[Customer validation quotes — in progress. Target: 10 conversations by end of June 2026.]

This isn't a thesis. China has been running it for a decade.



Daijia — Designated driving on demand. A driver arrives at your location on a foldable e-bike, stows it in your trunk, and drives you home in your own car. You pay through the app.

WHY IT WORKS

Zero fleet cost. The user keeps their car. The driver pool is decoupled from vehicle ownership. Unit economics survive in markets where labor is cheap relative to private vehicle cost.

LAUNCHED	July 2015
OPERATOR	Didi Daijia (Didi Chuxing)
CITIES	~200 in China
CONSOLIDATION	Didi acq. E-Daijia (Aug 2022)
GLOBAL CAGR	5%+ (2023–2030)

Why a dozen Western attempts have stalled.

† BeMyDD

US designated-driver app, ~2010s. Failed to reach unit economics in suburban markets — driver dispatch cost exceeded rider willingness to pay.

† Dryver

Still operating in select US cities, but stayed regional. Could not break out of franchise model.

† STEER

App-based DD service. Quiet exit; could not solve insurance liability at scale.

† Designated Driver Inc. To Arrive Alive (CA)

Acquired in 2022. Consolidation play; not a growth story.

The pattern: Three structural blockers in Western markets: (1) labor cost makes the model uneconomic vs Uber Black; (2) insurance liability for a non-owner driving an impaired customer's car is unsolved; (3) demand density never reaches the dispatch threshold. None of these apply with the same force in the African markets we target.

How Keys works.

One booking. Your car gets home. You get home. No retrievals. No Bolt workaround. No strangers.

01

Book via app or venue QR

At the bar, the car park, or pre-booked from home. Booking is instant — no negotiation, no cash.

02

Driver arrives on e-bike

A vetted, named driver arrives on a foldable e-bike. You see their photo, rating, and live ETA before they arrive.

03

They drive you home in your car

Driver stows the e-bike in your boot. You ride home in your own vehicle. No fleet cost. No stranger's car.

04

Morning retrieval — optional

Keys also offers morning-retrieval-only bookings. A second driver collects your car the next day.

Keys is not a taxi. It is the first product in Africa purpose-built for the car owner who drinks responsibly but has no safe way to keep their car overnight.

Built around the moment of decision.

Identity-verified drivers

Photo ID, background check, vehicle handling test before first ride.

Named & rated driver pool

See who's coming before they arrive. Trust is built before key handoff.



Pre-book or on-demand

Book at 8pm before drinks, or scan a venue QR at 1am. Both flows convert.



Venue QR integration

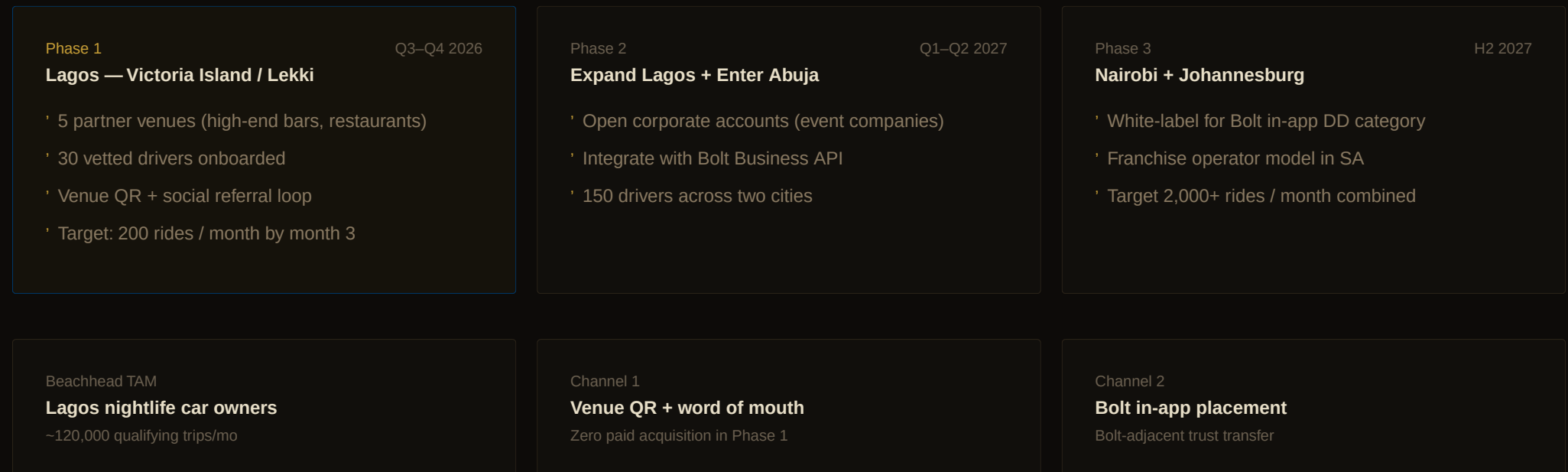
Partner venues display QR codes at the exit. The decision point becomes the booking point.

TECH STACK

[React Native](#)[Node.js](#)[Bolt Driver API](#)[Stripe](#)[Firebase](#)

Venue-first. City by city. Trust compounds.

We start where demand concentrates — Lagos nightlife — and expand only when unit economics are proven.



Simple take-rate. Multiple expansion levers.

Per-ride commission **20–25%**

Keys takes a platform fee on each booking. Driver keeps 75–80%. Transparent from day one.

Morning retrieval add-on **+\$,500**

Standalone next-day car-retrieval service. Higher margin — no driver competition, pure scheduling.

Venue partner subscriptions **50K/mo**

Premium venue placement, branded QR stands, analytics dashboard for repeat booking rates.

Corporate & event accounts **Custom**

Bulk rides pre-purchased by event companies, corporate offsites. Volume discount, monthly invoice.

ILLUSTRATIVE P&L AT 500 RIDES / MONTH

Avg. fare
\$12,000

Platform revenue (22%)
\$2,640/ride

Monthly GMV
\$6,000,000

The numbers work without subsidy.

DRIVER ECONOMICS

Avg. earnings per shift (4 rides × ₱9,000)	₱6,000
E-bike amortisation	2,500
Platform fee	9,000
Net driver take-home per shift	24,500
Shifts per month (part-time, 12)	294,000/mo

PLATFORM ECONOMICS

Revenue per ride	2,640
Support & insurance allocation	400
Payment processing (Stripe 1.5%)	180
Contribution per ride	2,060
Break-even (fixed costs ₱1.2M/mo)	~583 rides/mo

Key assumption: Driver supply from existing Bolt driver pool (part-time opt-in). No dedicated fleet. No driver salary. Capital-light from day one.

No direct competitor exists on the continent.

FEATURE	Keys	Bolt/Uber	Taxi	Two-Bolt WA
You keep your car				
No morning retrieval needed				
Vetted, named driver				
Price-competitive with 2 rides				
Works at 1am on demand				
No stranger's car				
In-app payment				

The two-Bolt workaround is the de facto competitor — and it costs more, requires two bookings, and leaves you without your car overnight. Keys wins on every axis that matters to this customer.

Building the right team, honestly.

Precious-Ryan Ndubuisi

Founder & CEO

Independent Web3 & Fintech BD Consultant. Has advised 7 African fintech and mobility startups on go-to-market across Nigeria, Kenya, and South Africa. Lived the designated-driver problem in Lagos for 4 years.

BD & Partnerships

West Africa GTM

Fintech Rails

CTO — Recruiting

Head of Engineering

Looking for a senior mobile engineer with experience in marketplace or logistics platforms. React Native + Node.js. Lagos-based or Lagos-willing preferred.

React Native

Marketplace

Logistics APIs

Open role

Ops Lead — Recruiting

Head of Driver Ops

Looking for someone with ride-hailing or last-mile logistics operations experience in Lagos. Has managed a driver pool of 50+ and understands the Bolt driver ecosystem.

Driver Ops

Lagos Logistics

Bolt Ecosystem

Open role

ADVISOR PIPELINE

[Bolt Nigeria contact]

Strategic partnership — pending warm intro confirmation

[Ex-Didi BD]

China model playbook — target outreach Q3 2026

Here is what we need from Bolt.

We are not asking Bolt to build this. We are asking Bolt to let us build it inside the ecosystem they already own.

01	Partnership Bolt Africa integration — in-app DD category placement and driver pool access.	USE OF \$50K SEED	
		Driver onboarding & vetting	~\$17,500
		App MVP (React Native)	~\$15,000
		Venue partnerships & BD	~\$7,500
		Insurance pilot + legal	~\$6,000
		Working capital	~\$4,000
02	Seed Capital \$50,000 pre-seed to prove Lagos unit economics and reach 600 rides/month.		
03	Warm Introductions Bolt Nigeria GM · Insurance underwriters (Stanbic, AXA Mansard) · Series A mobility VCs.		

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